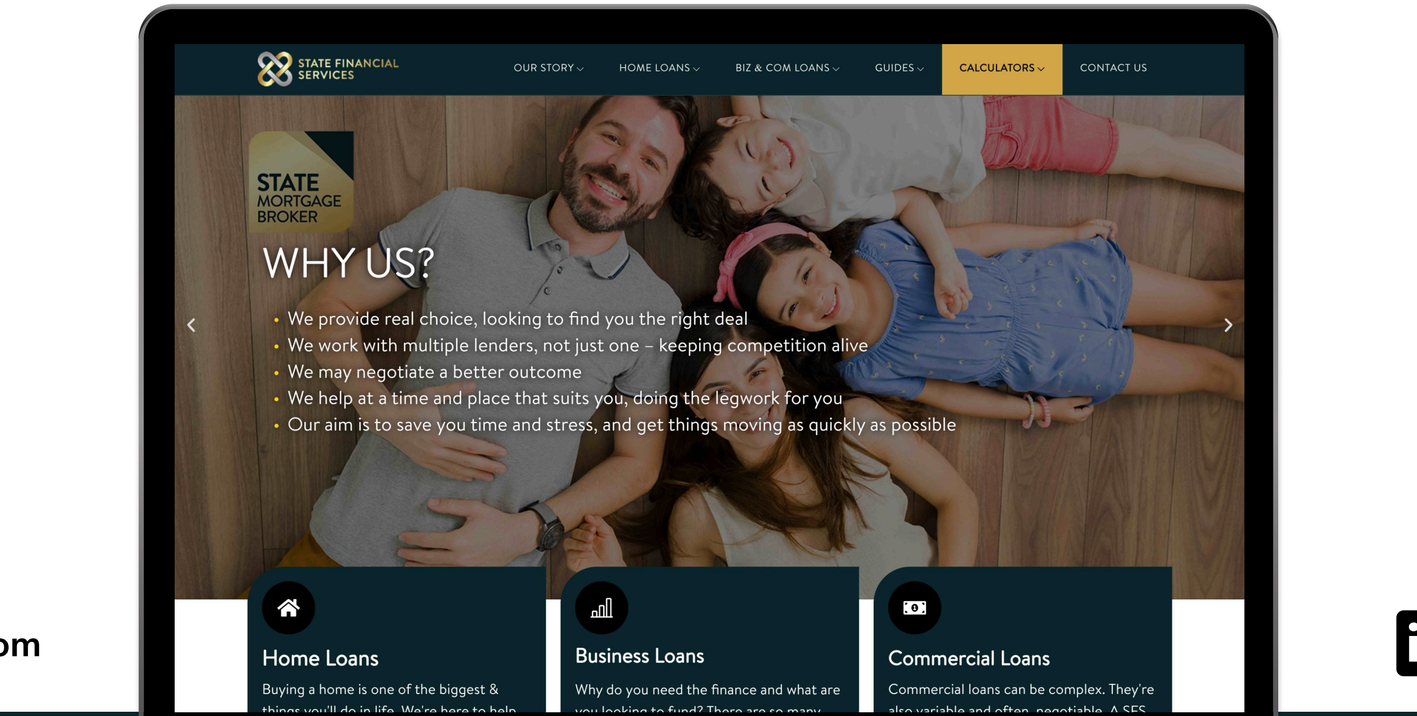
Design. Develop. Grow.

State Financial Services

UI/UX Improvement Summary with Suggestions



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Home page

According to **Hick's Law** (a UX best practice), experts recommend providing the **right amount of content on a page**, not too much, and not too little, as in both scenarios, users **may leave the site**

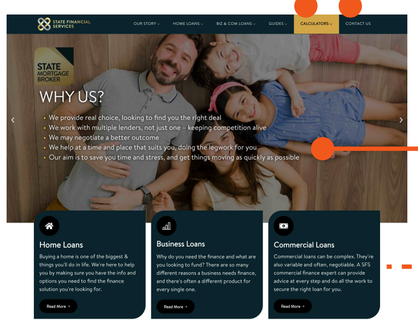
- The homepage currently has very limited content and offers no guidance to users on "What's next?".
- The solution should align with both the business strategy and usability goals, enabling users to efficiently find the information they need.

lead generation strategy is not clear. The "Calculate" option is highlighted, but it's unclear how this contributes to lead generation. Consider adding a "Contact an expert for a free consultation" CTA on the calculator page to support a clearer lead-generation user flow.

Strongly recommended: It would be better to have a **Case Study page (Success stories)**, as users are interested in seeing success stories, not just reviews, but how projects started, progressed, and the results achieved.

These could be presented as blog-style posts, which would also help with SEO.

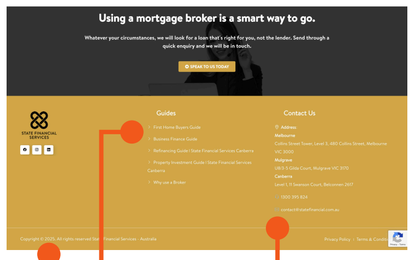
Based on competitor analysis (companies with more than 800 reviews), the navigation bar, phone number, and "Contact Us" button are prominently displayed, which supports conversions.

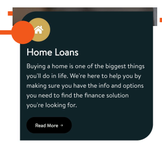


- The homepage hero banner is text-heavy, which negatively impacts conversion rates.
- The banner scrolls automatically, preventing users from reading the content.
- There is no strong above-the-fold conversion trigger for users ready to act immediately.

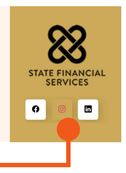
Strongly recommended

- Reduce the amount of text, focusing the main title, subtitle, and CTA to clearly communicate what you do and what makes you unique, your main **unique selling point**.
- The CTA should guide users toward the appropriate action. With access to Google Analytics or heatmaps, more reliable recommendations could be made on which CTA to use. But based on competitor analysis, most competitors direct users to "Talk to an expert" or "Get started."





Hover effects should be more prominent, as icons are currently not very visible.



Needs to be updated to the current year. In the backend, you can add automated code to update it automatically, so manual changes won't be necessary.

Strongly recommended to fix: The icons are not visible and need better contrast.

When users hover over a section, the icon colour changes, indicating a hover effect. This can create an expectation that the section is clickable, but it's not.

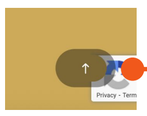
Strongly Recommended: It would be better to link the entire section, which could also help improve conversion rates.

Hover effects and CTA styles are inconsistent, and the black outline looks out of place, lowering the perceived quality of the website.

Recommendation: Create a design system and maintain it consistently to strengthen brand identity.

It would be better to follow best practices for the footer.

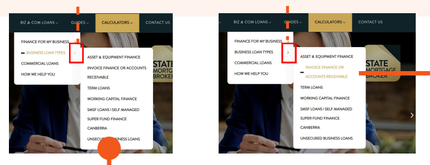
Read: https://www.nngroup.com/articles/footers/



Strongly recommended to fix: This element is blinking, which is distracting because it draws the user's attention away from other content on the website.

Recommendation: Remove the blinking effect.

The arrow disappears when the user scrolls down to other sections, which is not a good user experience. It's better to keep the same interaction throughout, otherwise, users may get confused.

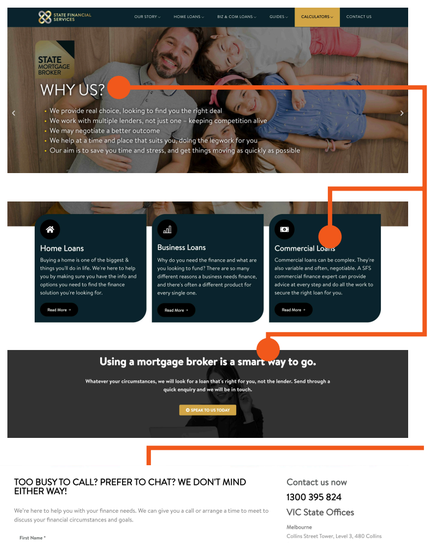


Strongly recommended to fix:

- All-caps text is **hard to read** when the content is long. Using title case or sentence case would improve readability.
- Adjusting the line height would further enhance readability and improve the overall quality of the website.

Strongly recommended to fix:

- The text colour changes on hover and shows a hand cursor, but nothing happens when it's clicked. It would be better to remove the hand cursor, otherwise, users may get confused.
- The system status is not visible. When users navigate to the Commercial Loan page, the navigation bar does not indicate which page they are on. It's recommended to show the user's current location by adding **breadcrumbs** and highlighting the active main navigation item.



Strongly recommended to fix for SEO:

Heading styles are inconsistent across the website. H1, H2, H3 ect. should be applied consistently to improve hierarchy and readability.

Capitalisation also inconsistent

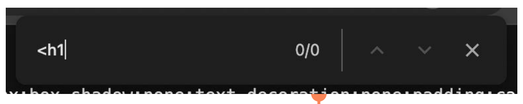
Title case usage is not consistent in entire website. Using all caps for longer text is hard to read.

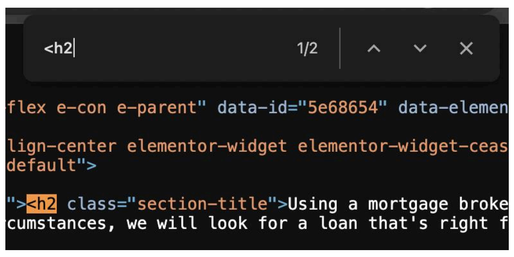
Page SEO

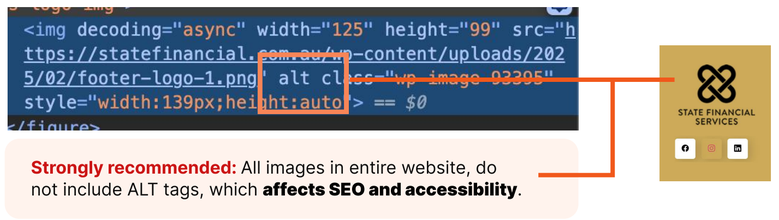
The page **does not have an H1 tag**. This has a high **impact on SEO**, as every page should have one H1 tag. I checked the code and could not find an H1 on the page.

Strongly recommended

This should be fixed in every pages



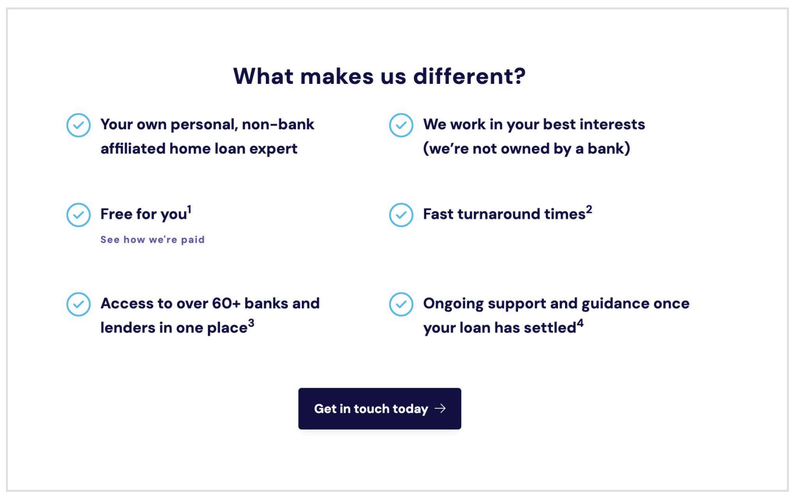




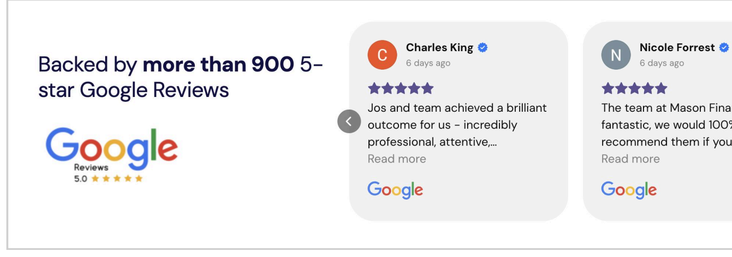
Strongly recommended: All images in entire website, do not include ALT tags, which **affects SEO and accessibility**.

Homepage elements identified through competitor analysis that are currently missing

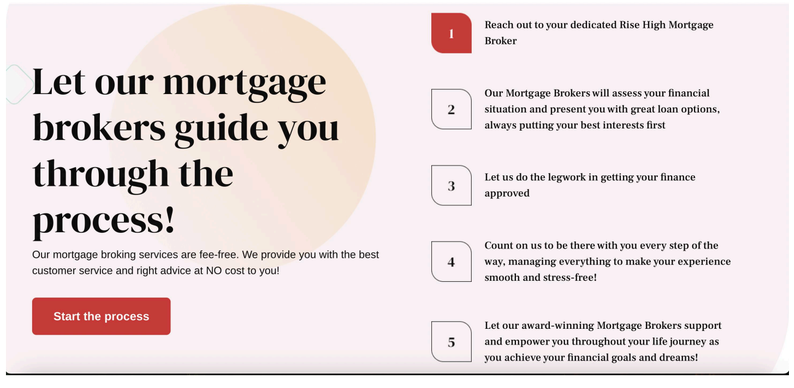
1. Why you are different from others



2. User reviews

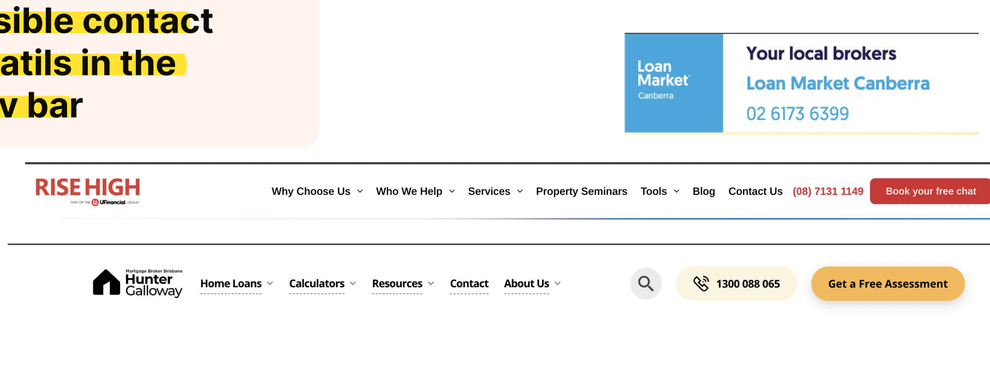


3. Your process



4. Visible CTA in the banner

5. Visible contact deatils in the nav bar



Contact us page

When users are on the Contact Us page, this is not clearly indicated in the navigation bar. It would be better to show an active state for the current menu item. CTAs should also have defined hover, active, and inactive styles in the stylesheet to improve clarity and consistency.

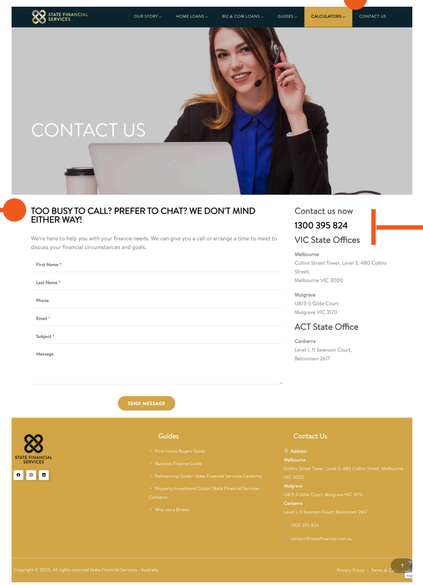
Read more : https://www.nngroup.com/articles/contact-us-pages/

"Too busy to call?" may be interpreted as sarcastic by some users. Instead, it's better to phrase it more neutrally:

"Prefer to speak or chat? Choose the option that works best for you."

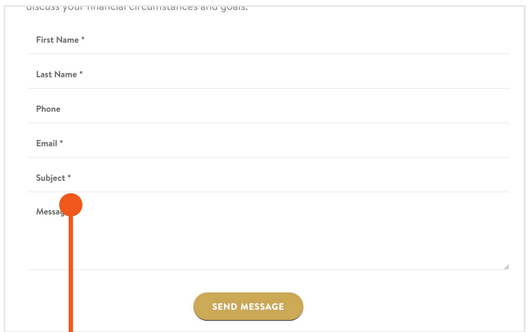
Also, using ALL CAPS for longer text should be avoided, as it reduces readability.

Strongly recommended: Use sentence case or title case instead, and ensure this is consistent across the entire website based on the styles used on other pages.



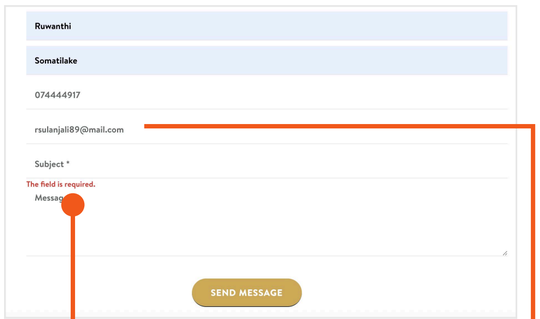
The content is cluttered. It would be better to visually group related information, for example, separate phone numbers from location details.

Adjusting the spacing and dividing sections will improve readability and organisation.



Strongly recommended: The fields are marked as visible, but it's not clear that they are mandatory.

Some users may not notice this icon. Providing a small note at the top of the form could help avoid confusion and reduce errors.

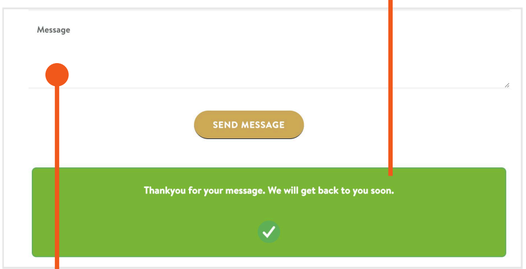


Errors are currently indicated only with red text, which may not be visible to colour-blind users or people with certain neurodivergences. It's better to include an error icon alongside the text, as recommended by accessibility experts.

It's better to tell users **when you're available and when to expect a reply** on the Contact Us page.

Also, in the thank-you message, include something like: "If you need urgent assistance, please call and provide your phone number."

Analysis of user behaviour videos shows that users actively click on phone no after the submitted the form, which can be helpful for lead generation.



Strongly recommended to fix: Users can submit the form with errors or without filling in the message. If they accidentally submit the form without providing a valid email or phone number, your team won't be able to contact them, which can result in lost leads.

Page SEO

The page **does not have an H1 tag**. This has a high **impact on SEO**, as every page should have one H1 tag. I checked the code and could not find an H1 on the page.

Recommendation:

This should be fixed in every pages

Extra point: Considering the **lead generation user flow**, some users visit the form, then navigate to the team page to check the key contact person's name before returning to fill out the form (User behaviour recordings show this pattern)

Providing the key contact person's name directly on the form would help users avoid this back-and-forth, reducing frustration and the risk of leaving the site, especially important for a smaller team.

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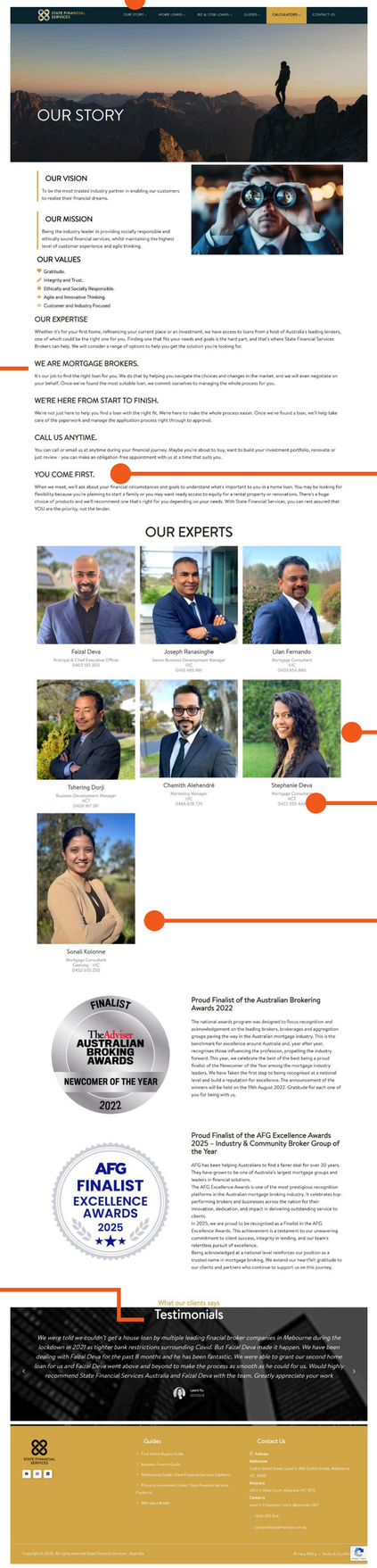
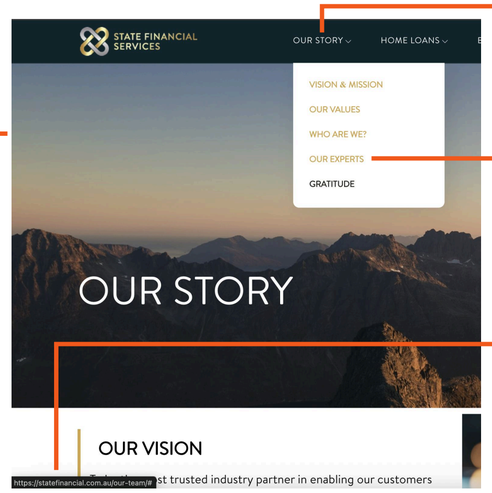
Our story page

Strongly recommended to fix: The page currently lacks a CTA that directs users to the lead-generation flow. Consider adding “Speak to our experts” linking to the Contact Us page, or a “Free consultation” CTA.



Strongly recommended to fix: Using ALL CAPS for longer text should be avoided, as it reduces readability.

Also, some titles use ALL CAPS, some use title case, and others use sentence case. This should be made consistent across the website.



Even though the “Our Story” has a landing page, it’s not linked.

Most users are more interested in “Our Team”. Since you already have an Our Team section and URL, it’s recommended to prioritise directing users there first.

Currently, the URLs are inconsistent, the page is titled “Our Story” but the URL is “Our Team”.

Strong Recommendation: Rename “Our Story” to “About Us” and create a separate page for “Our Team”, as this is the page most users look for before engaging with the service.

On the “Our Team” page, consider adding customer reviews and each expert’s details, including expertise and case studies, either as pop ups or on separate pages for each team member. User behaviour analysis shows that users often check this information before contacting you.

Strongly recommended: The phrase “You come first” needs rewording. Users might misunderstand it, thinking they need to come physically **first** or that they’re being prioritised because most users skim content. While adding a title is good, the title should be clear and easily understandable.

Strongly recommended: A similar page for the team profile, as users prefer to learn about expertise, case studies, and customer feedback there - **https://risehigh.com.au/our-team/james-schulze/**

Strongly recommended: Background and foreground colors do not have a sufficient contrast ratio.

Strongly recommended: All the images do not include ALT tags, which **affects SEO and accessibility**.

```
<img loading="lazy" decoding="async" width="1920" height="2560" src="https://statefinancial.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/EDIT-01-scaled.jpg" class="attachment-full size-full wp-image-99419" alt srcset="https://statefinancial.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/EDIT-01-scaled.jpg 1920w, https://statefinancial.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/EDIT-01-768x1024.jpg 768w, https://statefinancial.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/EDIT-01-1152x1536.jpg 1152w, https://statefinancial.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/EDIT-01-1536x2048.jpg 1536w, https://statefinancial.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/EDIT-01-1200x1600.jpg 1200w" sizes="(max-width: 1920px) 100vw, 1920px"> == $0
```

Page SEO

The page **does not have an H1 tag**. This has a high **impact on SEO**, as every page should have one H1 tag. I checked the code and could not find an H1 on the page.

Recommendation:

This should be fixed in every pages

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Home lone pages

Strongly recommended to fix: To fulfil usability goals of efficiency and effectiveness, it is **better to have a dedicated landing page for "Home Loans"** that includes all related services.

Currently, these services are only accessible through the navigation bar, requiring users to click through each item individually.

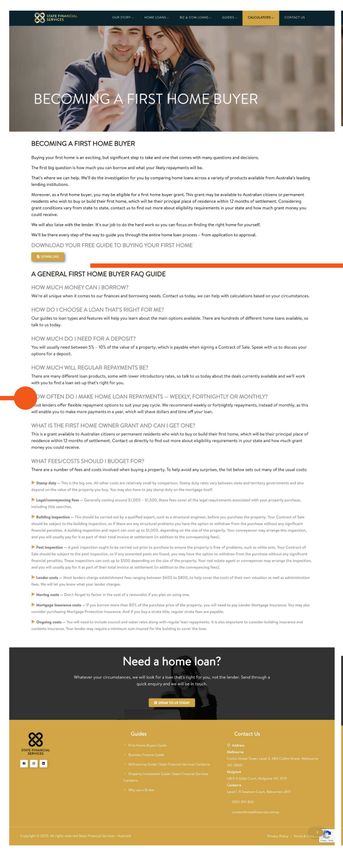
If users cannot find what they are looking for quickly, they are likely to leave the site.

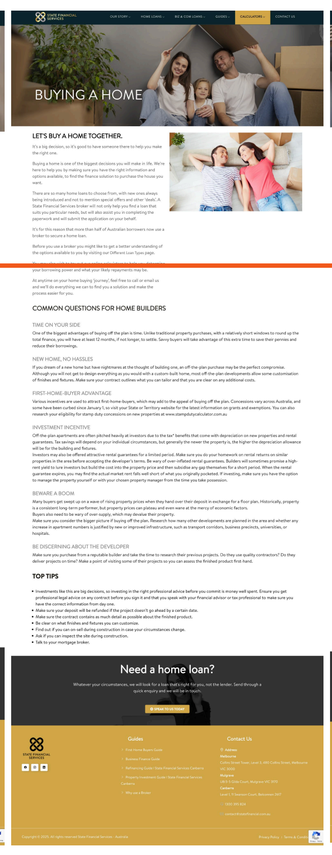
Strongly recommended to fix: Even though all pages fall under the "Home Loans" service, each page has a different structure. It is recommended to make the **page structure consistent**.

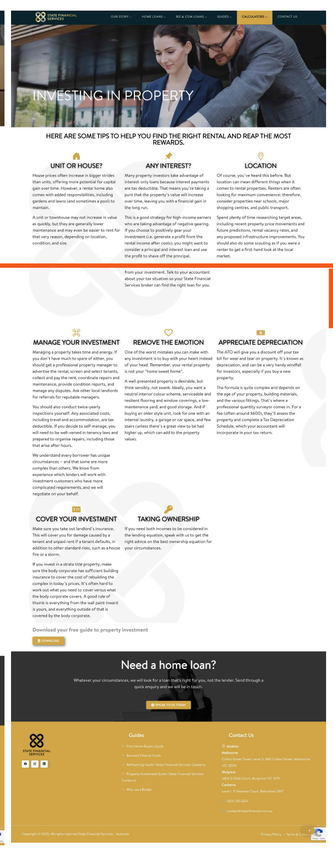
Pages are very text-heavy, so users may not scroll down to find the CTA.

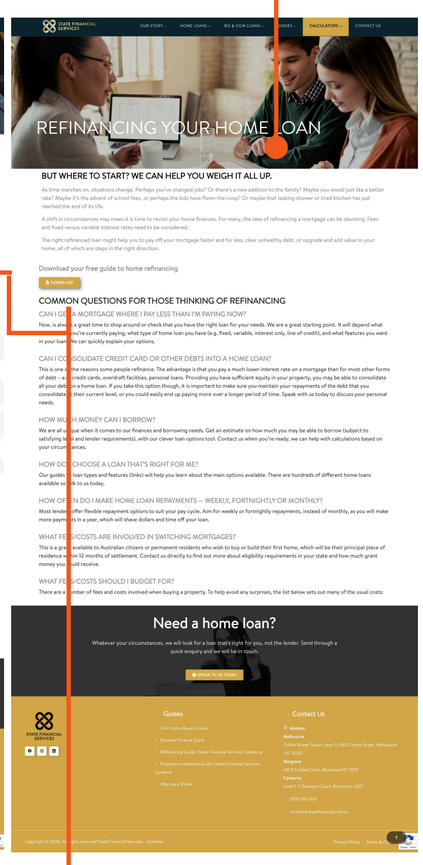
Strongly recommended to fix: There is no guidance for users on what to do next to support lead generation for the company, adding clear **next-step CTAs would help**.

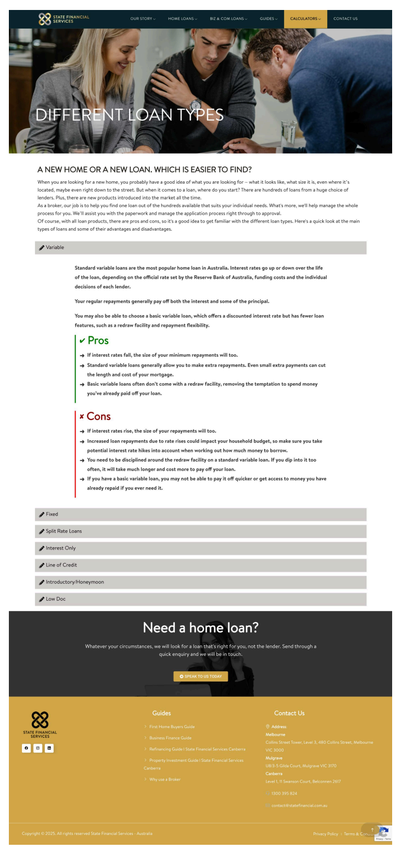
No prominent CTA is placed above the fold

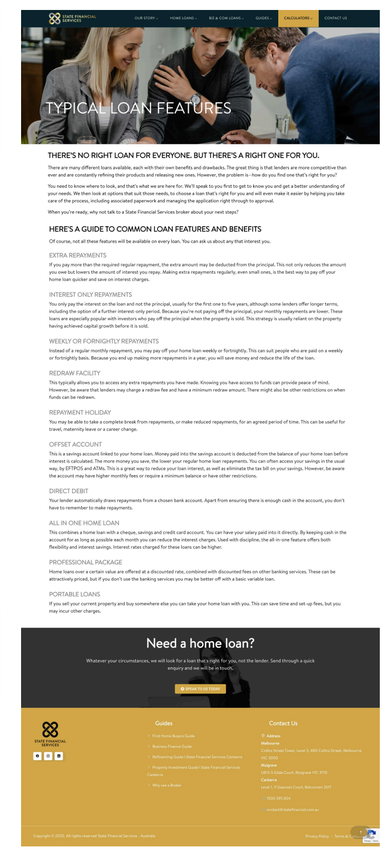






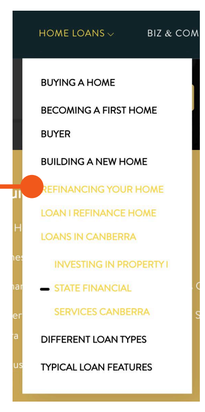


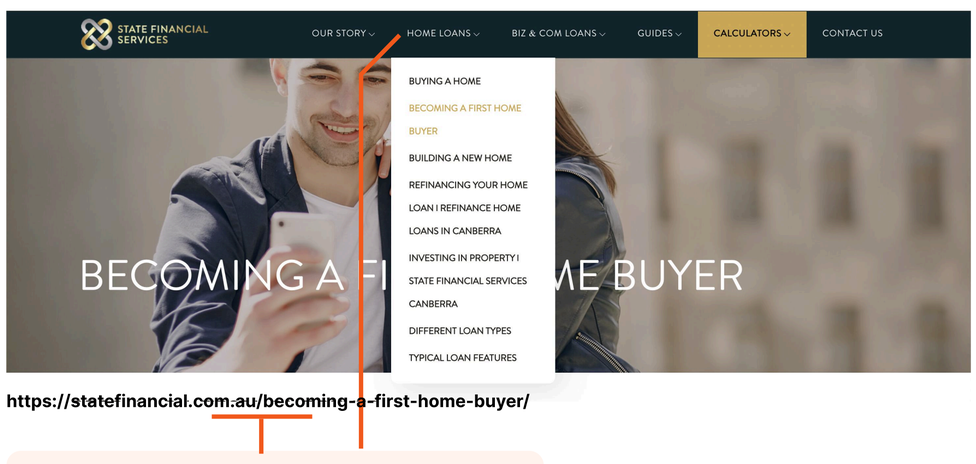




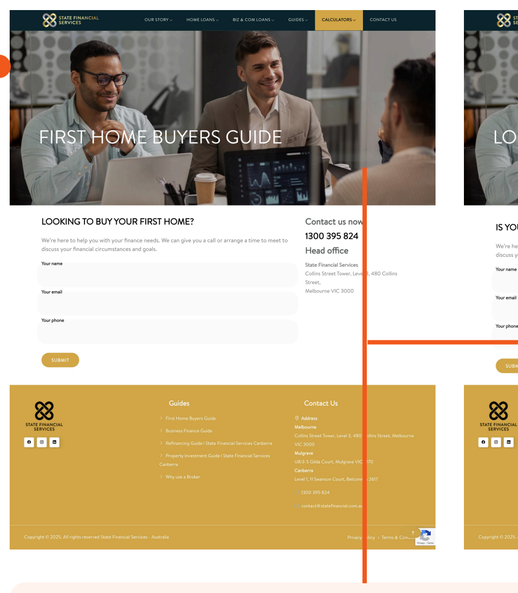
Strongly recommended to fix: Using ALL CAPS for longer text should be avoided, as it reduces readability.

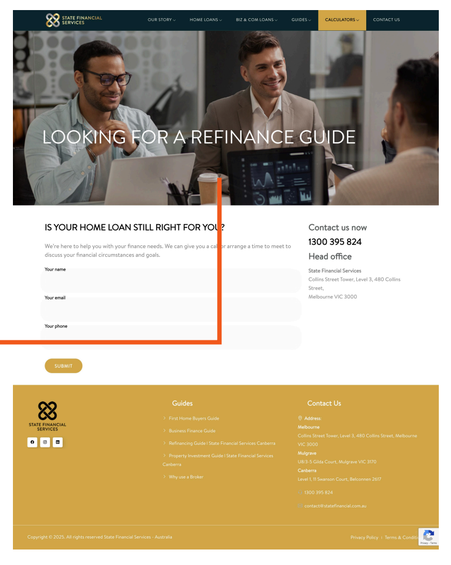
Strongly recommended to fix: Need to fix the colour contrast, as the text is not clearly visible.





https://statefinancial.com.au/becoming-a-first-home-buyer/





Two different pages use the same banner but have different titles.

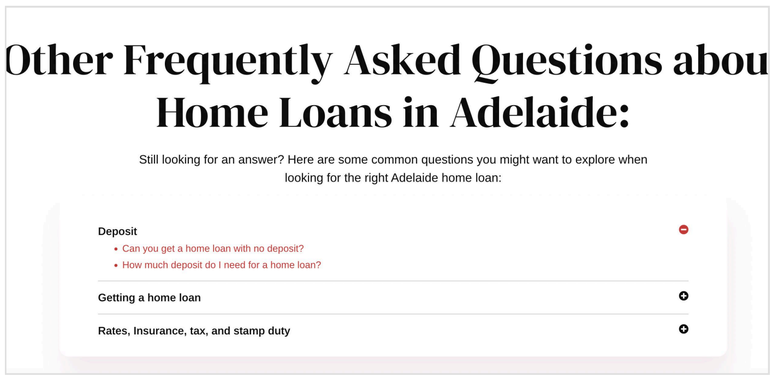
All the guide pages has the same banner. Better change.

Strongly recommended to fix: Even when users are on the "Home Loans" page, the current location is not visible, and the URL does not show the page path.

It is recommended to fix the URL structure, as this impacts SEO, and to add breadcrumbs to improve navigation and context for users.

Services page elements identified through competitor analysis that are currently missing

1. FAQs



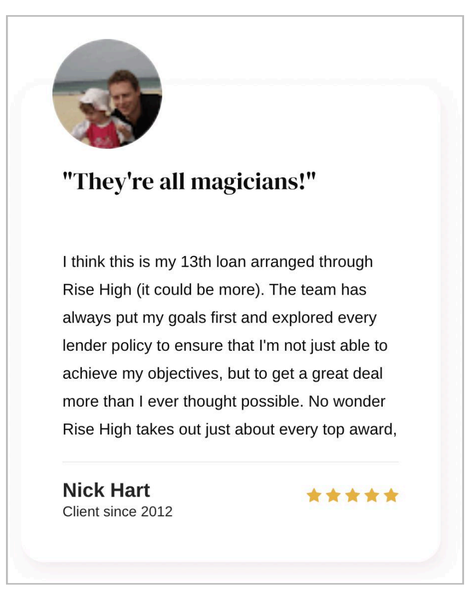
2. Key contact person and form are easily accessible

Other competitors do not have this feature, but user behaviour analysis shows that users do fill out this form, indicating it is helpful for the lead-generation flow.

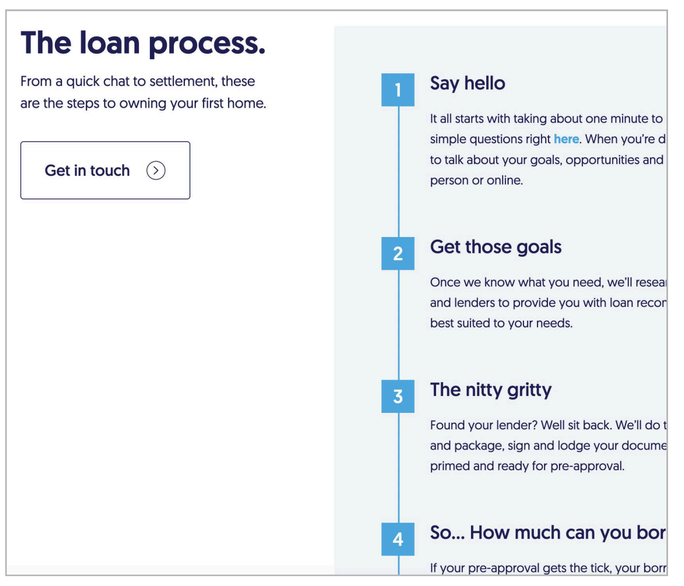
3. Success stories/ Case study

Other competitors do not have this feature, but user behaviour analysis shows that users do fill out this form, indicating it is helpful for the lead-generation flow.

4. Review of the specific services

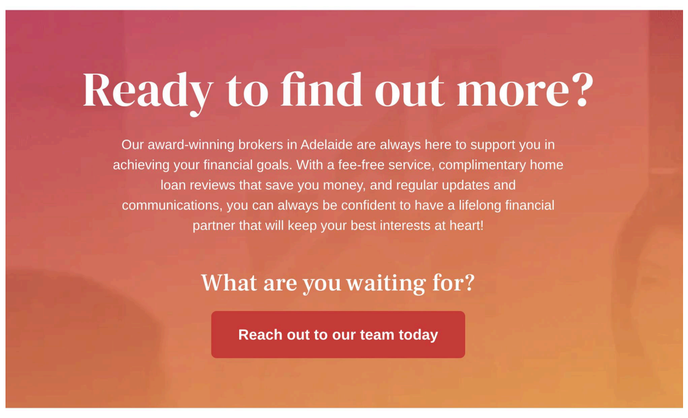


5. Process related to service

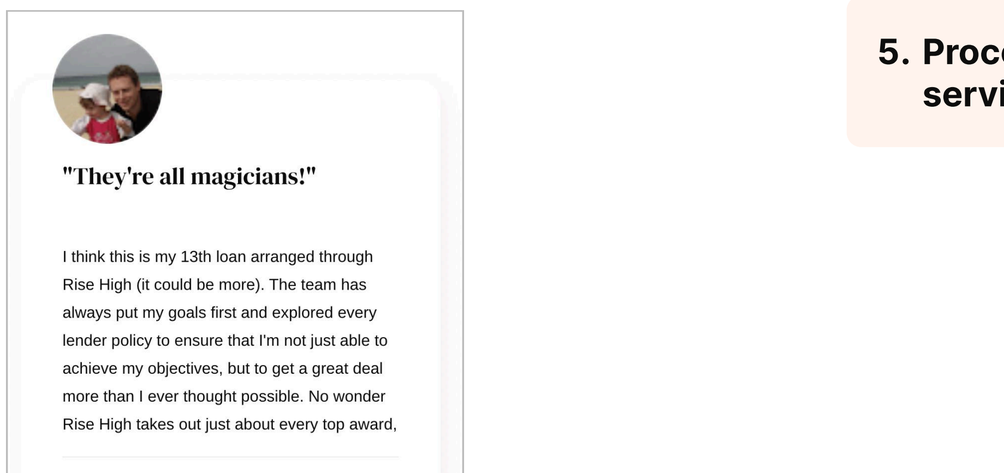


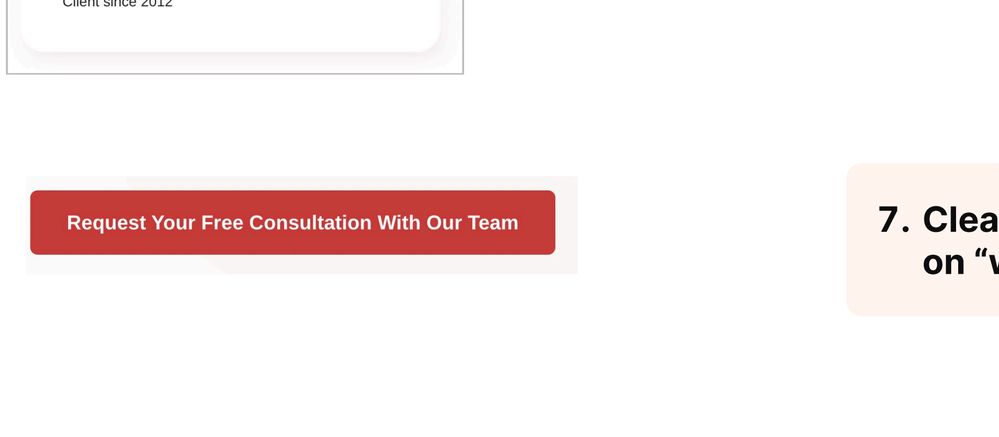
6. Prominent above-the-fold CTA, which drives higher conversions

7. Clearly direct users on "what to do next"



8. Check eligibility or calculator





Page SEO

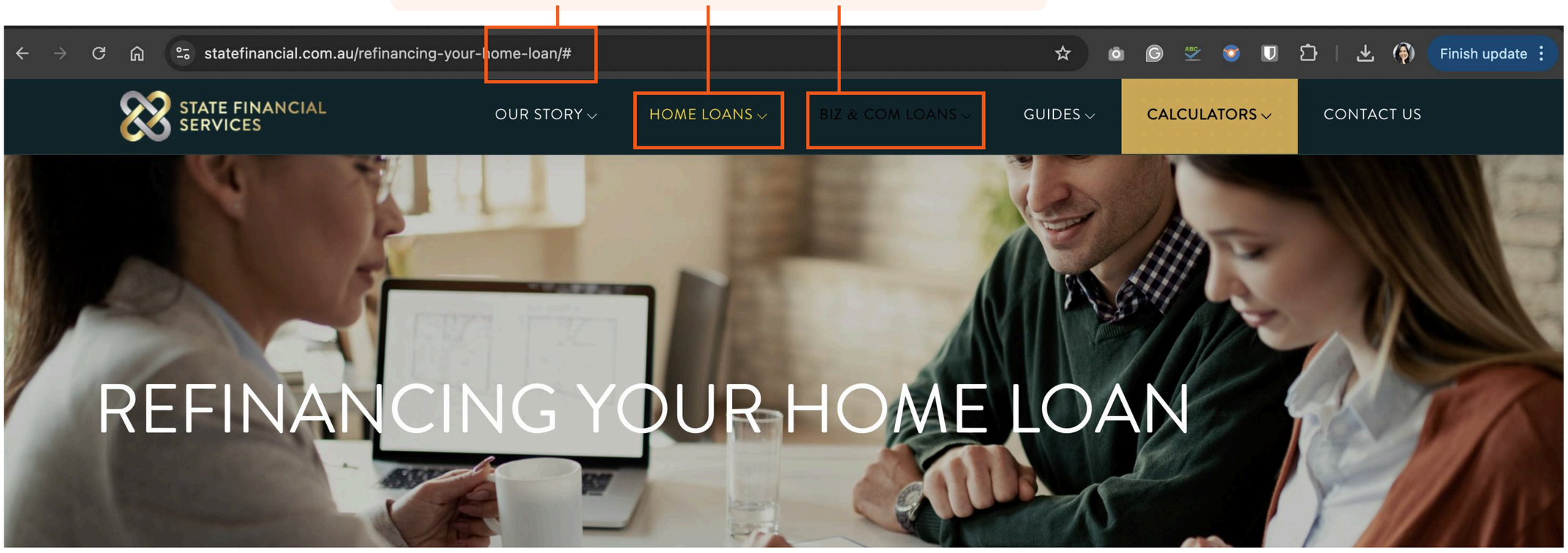
The page **does not have an H1 tag or ALT tags**. This has a high **impact on SEO**, as every page should have one H1 tag. I checked the code and could not find an H1 on the page.

Recommendation:

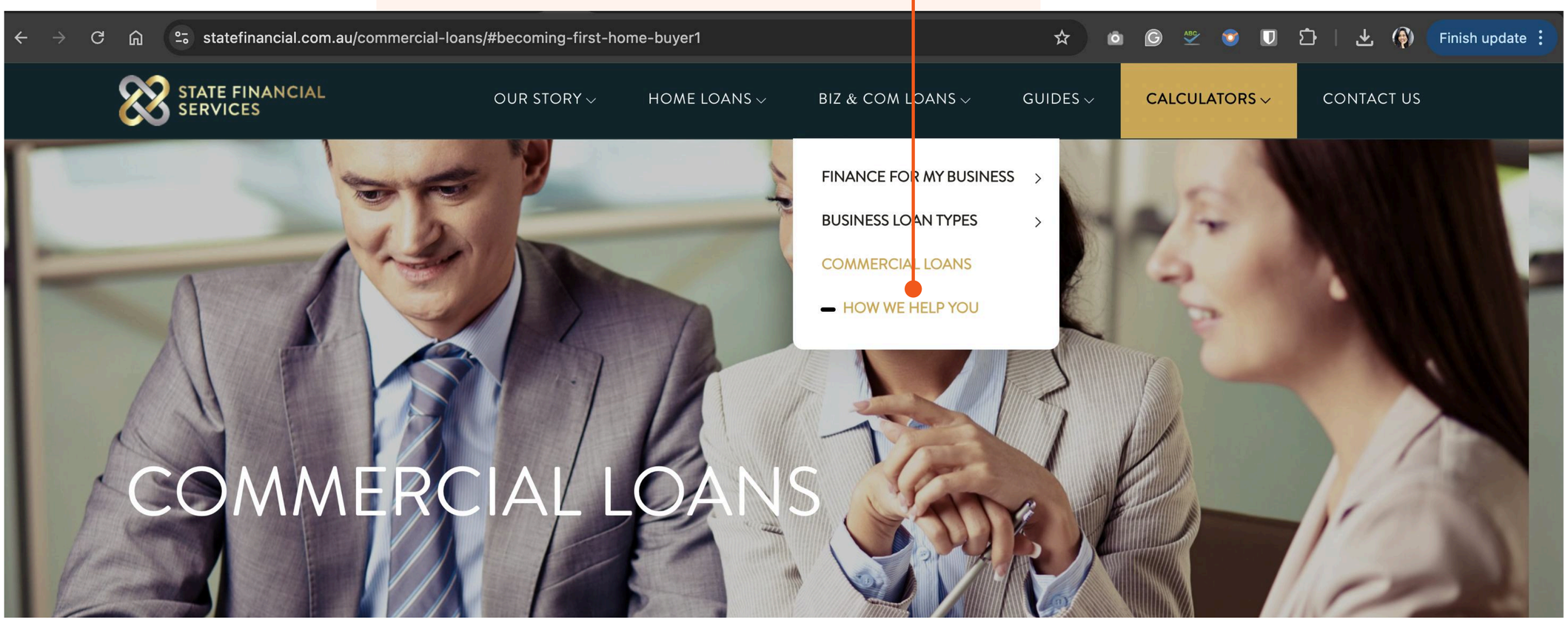
This should be fixed in every pages

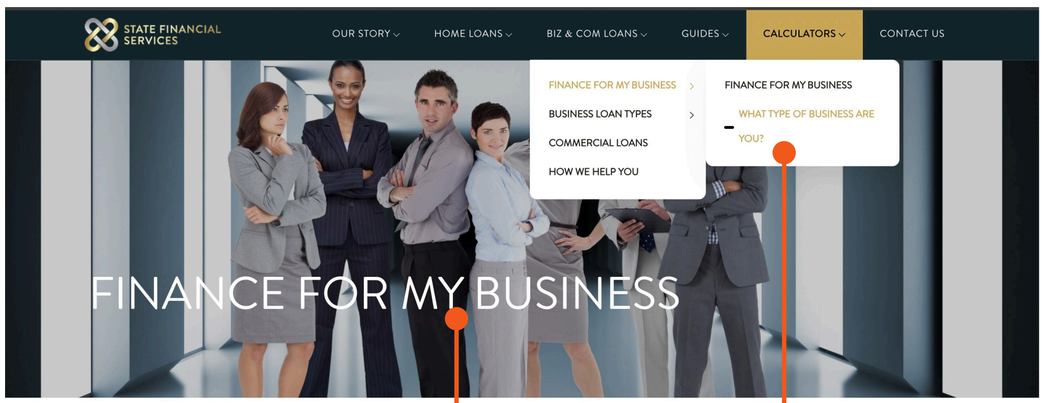
Nav bar

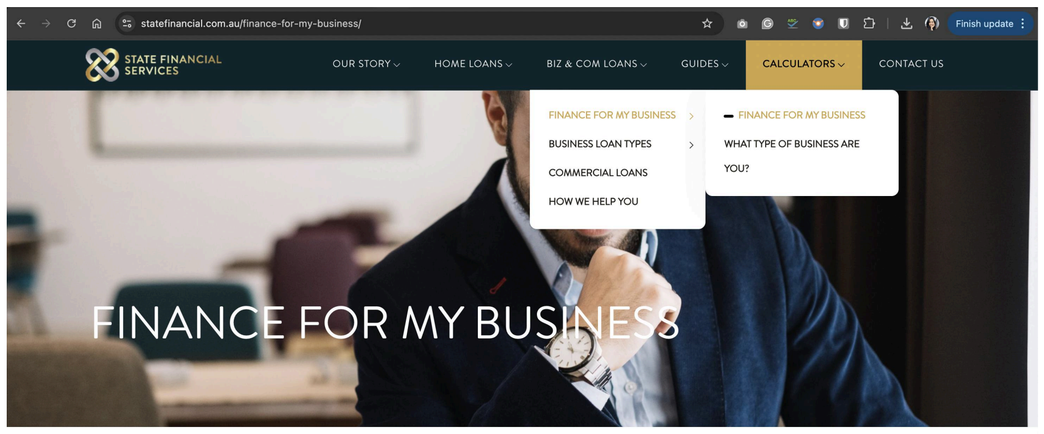
Strongly recommended to fix: When on the “Home Loans” subpage, clicking “Biz and Com Loans” does not navigate to a dedicated landing page, the URL changed (“#”) and the user stays on the same “Home Loans” subpage. Then, when scrolling, the “Biz and Com Loans” menu item is not highlighted and turns black, making it unclear which section the user is in.



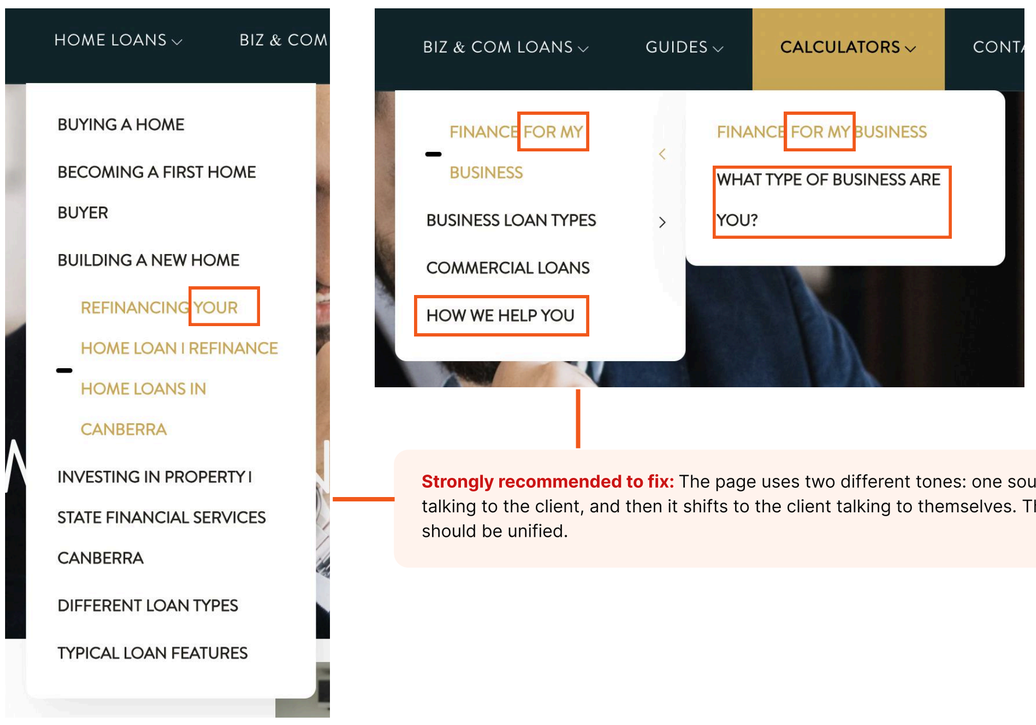
Strongly recommended to fix: “How we help you” nav item is not working







Strongly recommended to fix: On the “What type of business are you” page, the two titles are incorrect, they are the same as those on the “Finance for my business” page.

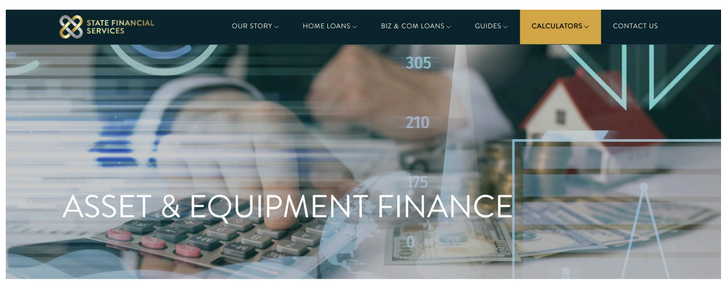


Strongly recommended to fix: The page uses two different tones: one sounds like the business is talking to the client, and then it shifts to the client talking to themselves. The tone is inconsistent and should be unified.

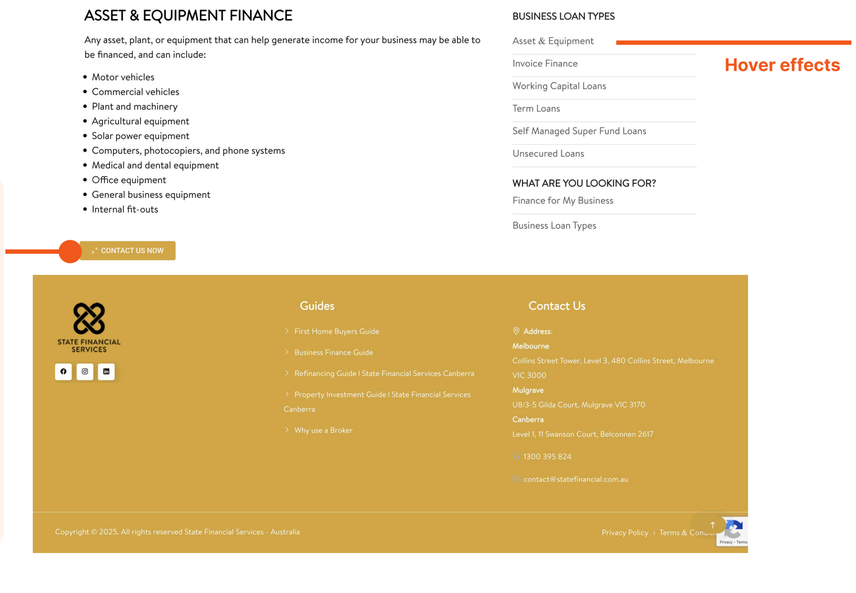
Design. Develop. Grow.

Biz & Com Loans pages

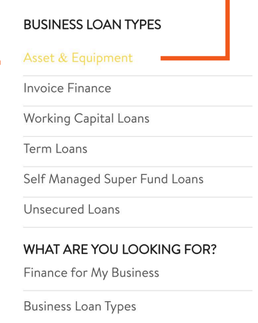
Strongly recommended to fix: The same issues identified on the “Home Loans” landing page and service page items also apply here.



Strongly recommended to fix: The hover effect colour should be fixed; otherwise, the light yellow is hard to see on the white background.



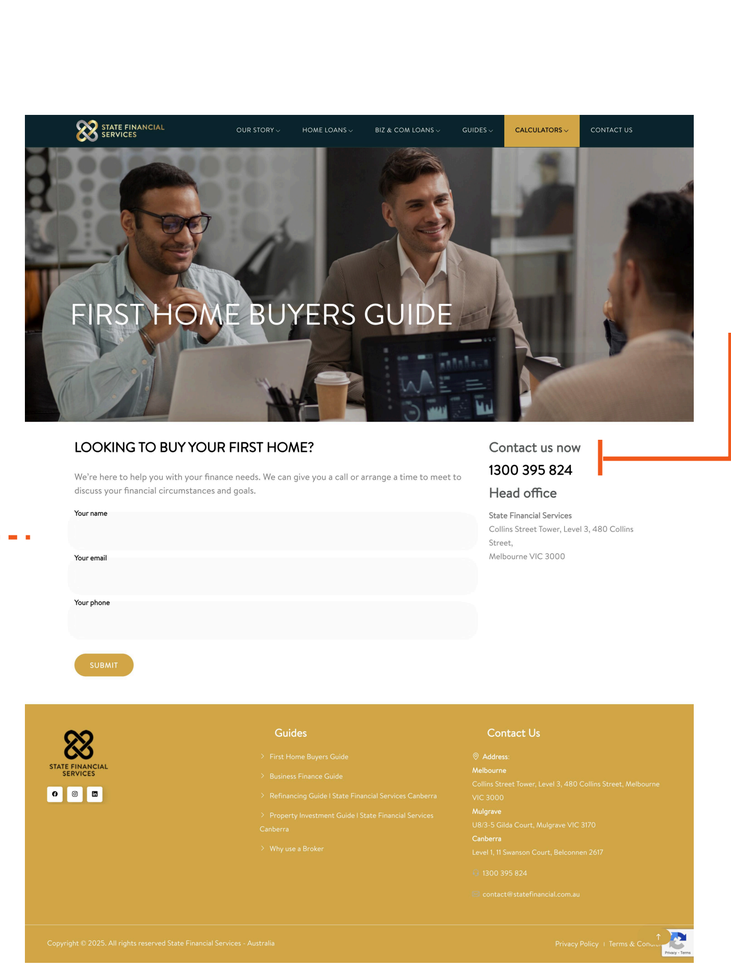
Hover effects



Strongly recommended to fix: CTA styles are not consistent throughout the website, it is recommended to standardise them to maintain consistency.

The “Contact Us” CTA has an icon that suggests it will reduce the page, but users actually have to click “Contact Us Now,” which navigates to a different page. This is misleading.

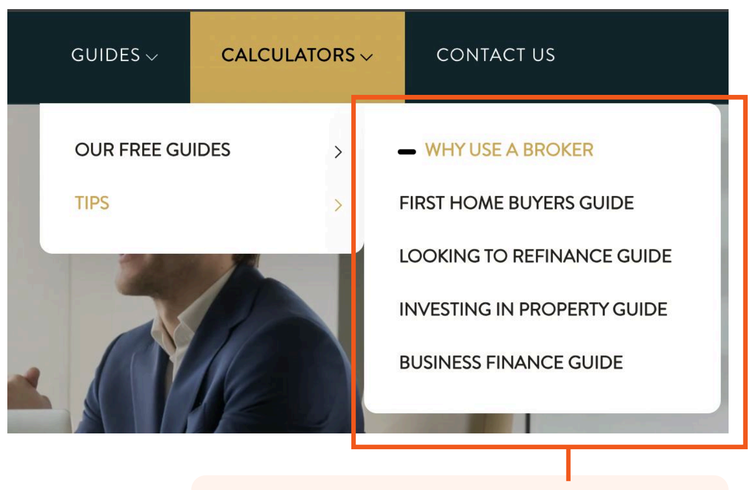
It is better to remove the misleading icon or update it with a standard icon that clearly indicates navigation (“Go”).



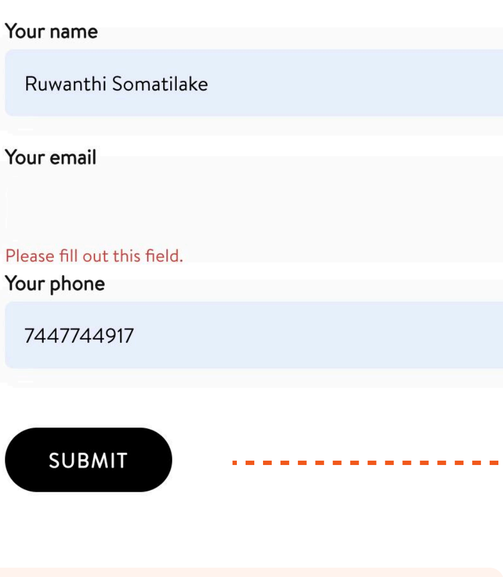
Guide pages

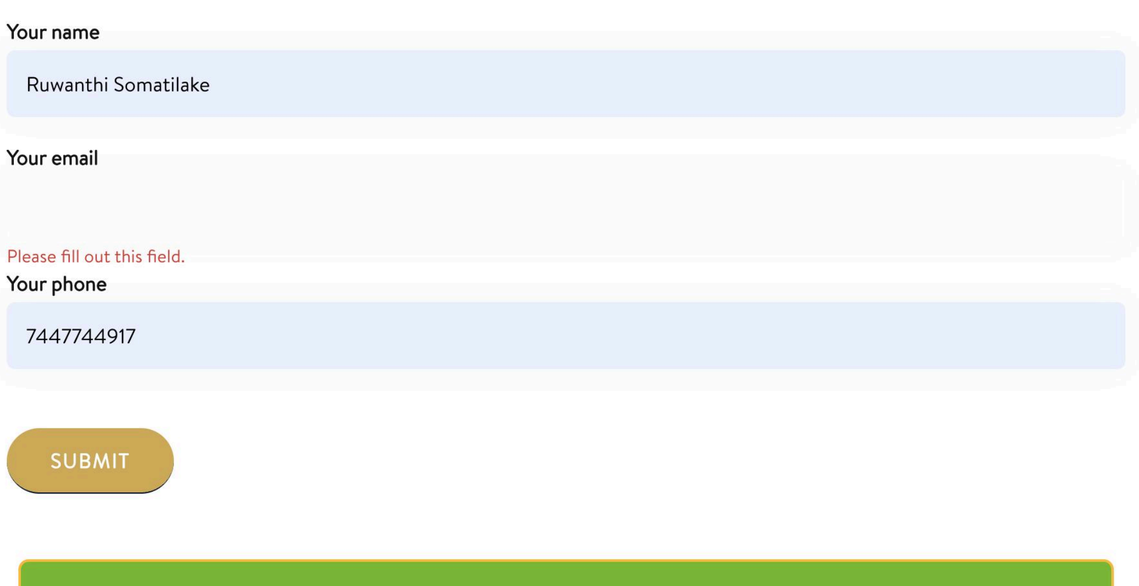
The content is cluttered. It would be better to visually group related information, for example, separate phone numbers from location details.

Adjusting the spacing and dividing sections will improve readability and organisation.



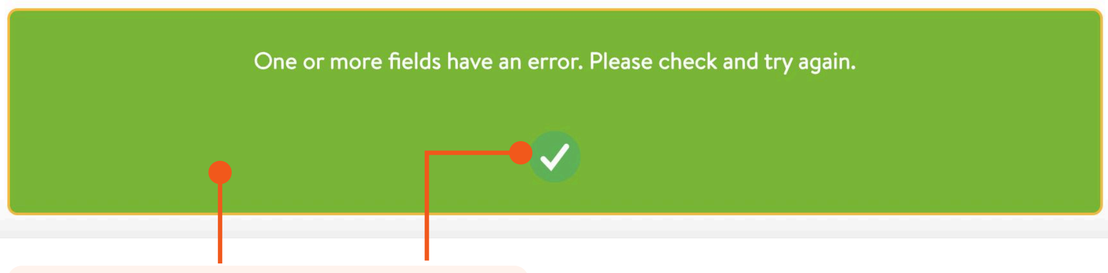
All the guide pages has the same banner. Better change.





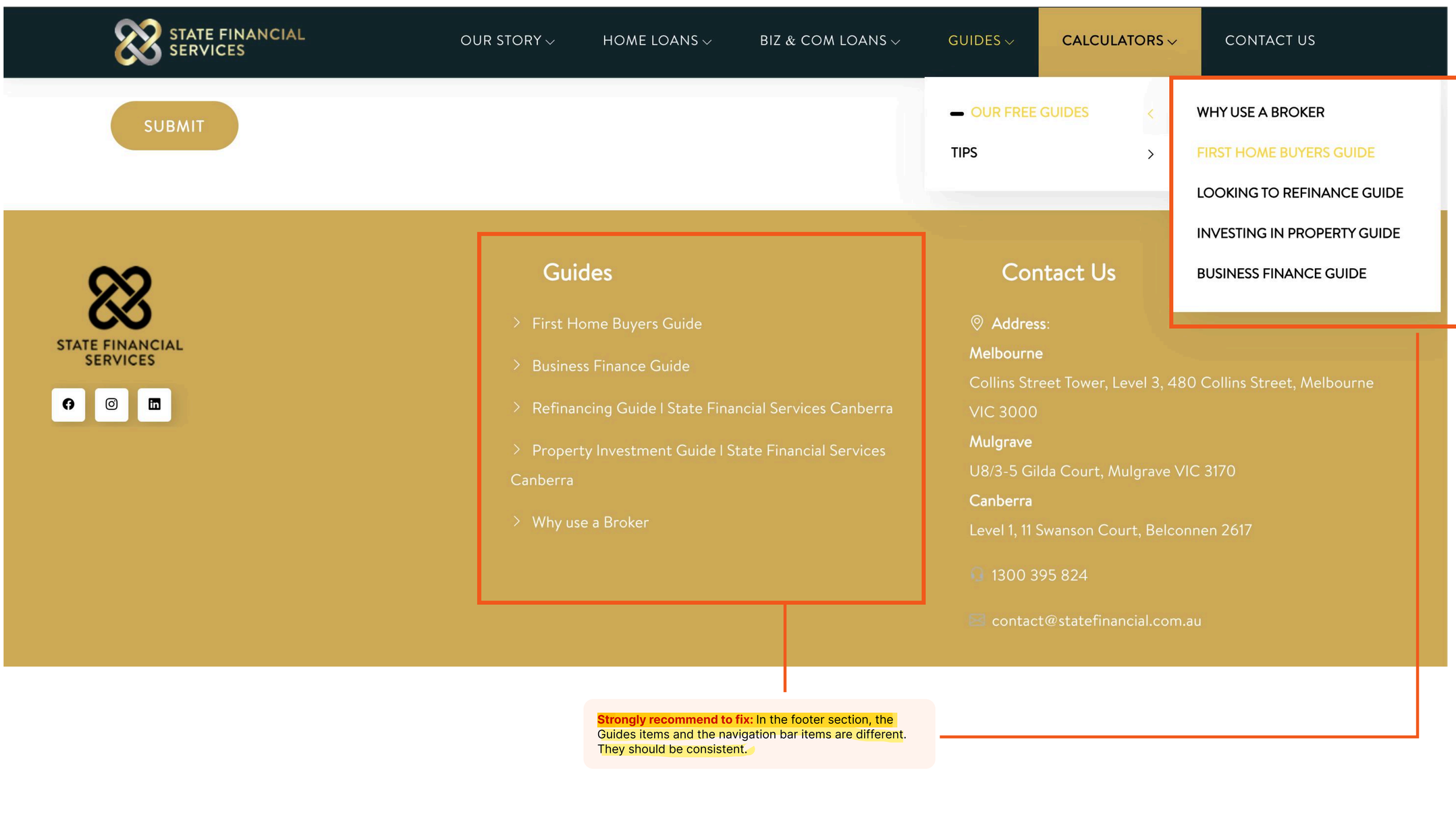
Strongly recommend to fix: The fields are not marked as mandatory, but it’s not clear that they are mandatory.

Errors are currently indicated only with red text, which may not be visible to colour-blind users or people with certain neurodivergences. It’s better to include an error icon alongside the text, as recommended by accessibility experts.



Strongly recommend to fix: This is an error message, but it’s shown in green with a tick, which typically indicates success or safety.

Since users often focus on visuals first rather than reading the text, this can be confusing. It’s better to use **red or include an error icon** instead of the green tick.



Strongly recommend to fix: In the footer section, the Guides items and the navigation bar items are different. They should be consistent.

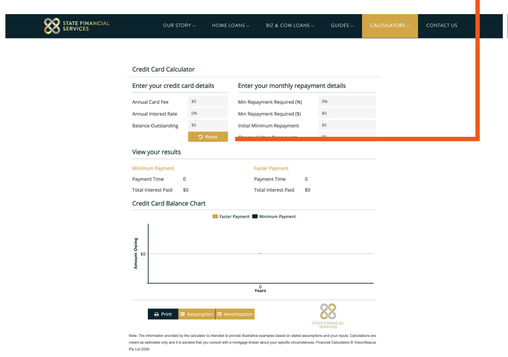
Tips pages

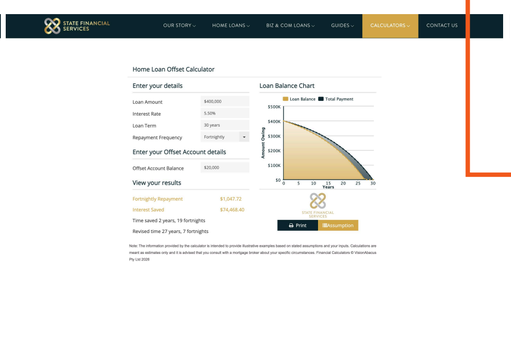
Strongly recommended to fix: The entire website's above-the-fold hero banner should include a CTA to support the lead-generation user flow, as CTAs in the hero banner typically have the highest conversion rates.

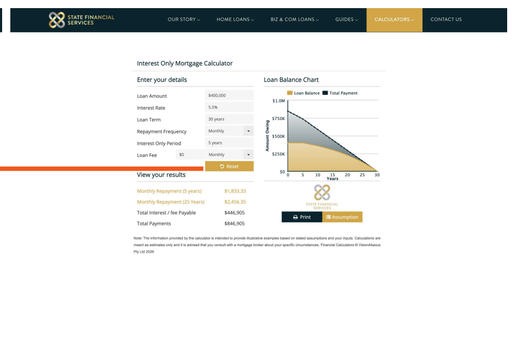
Strongly recommended to fix: All the text is left-aligned, but this section is center-aligned, which makes the page look broken.

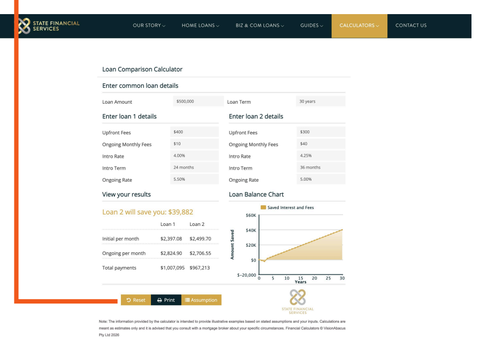
Calculator pages

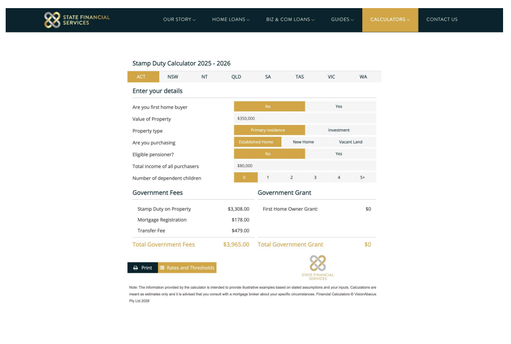
Strongly recommended to fix: Some pages have a Reset button, which is good, but this should be consistent across the site. Pages without a reset button should have one added, and the button's position should be the same on all pages.

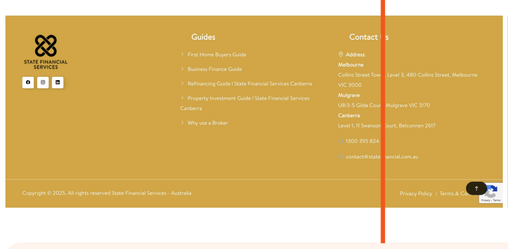


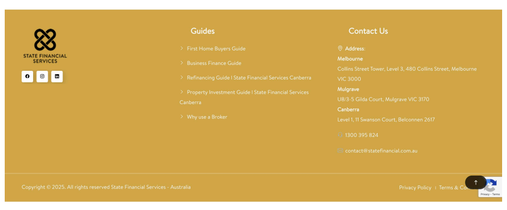


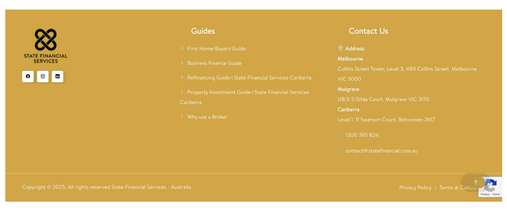


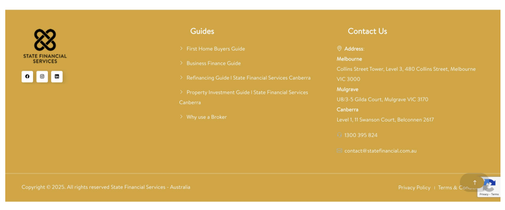


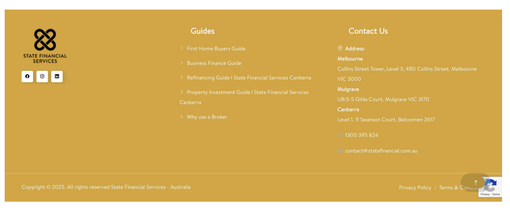








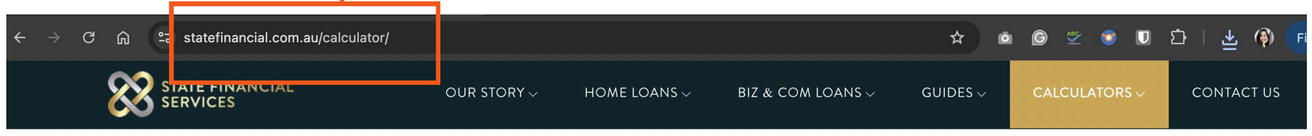


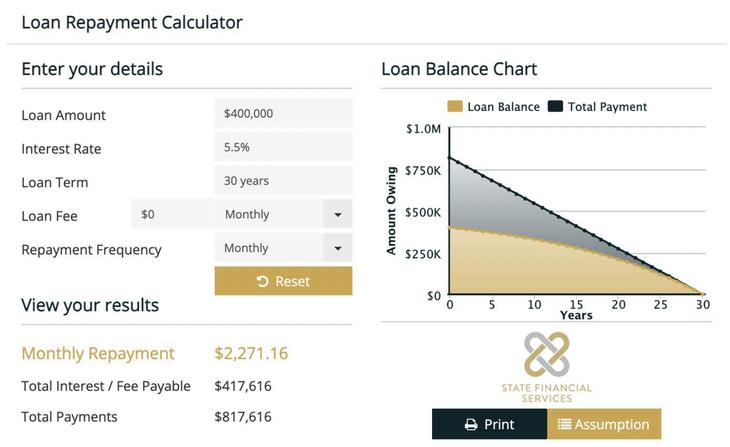


Strongly recommended to fix: The bottom of the pages has lot of white space.

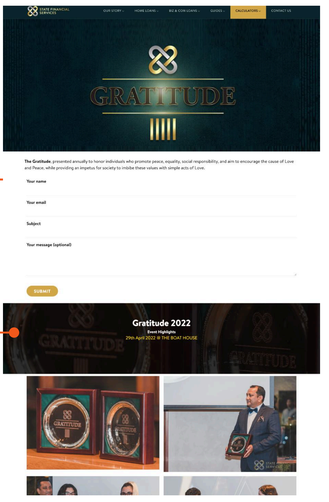
Currently, pages don't guide users on what to do next. It would be better to include the **key contact person's details** and a **form** at the bottom, which would help with lead generation.

Strongly recommended to fix: All other calculator pages URL has the same title name, but the "Loan Repayment Calculator" page URL is simply /calculator. It's better to update this for SEO by using a more descriptive URL.





Gratitude pages



Strongly recommended to fix: It's not clear why users need to fill out the form on the Gratitude page. The page should clearly explain the purpose of the form and why users should complete it.

Strongly recommended to fix: In the first description (Before the form), it says the gratitude is presented annually, but the page still shows "2022". This outdated text should be removed.

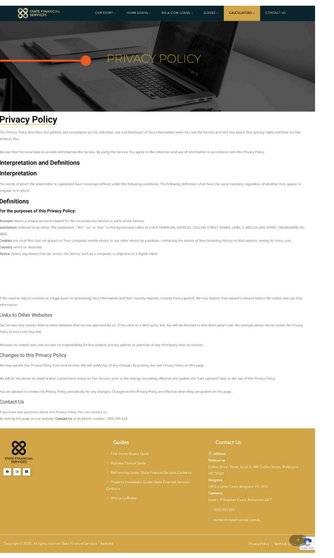
Privacy pages/ Terms and Conditions

This page layout is inconsistent with other pages.

The title is yellow, but only on this page.

The Privacy Policy/Terms and Conditions text is underlined in yellow, which also appears only here.

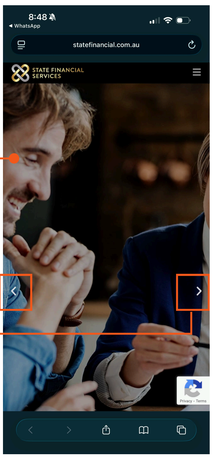
It's better to maintain consistency across all pages.



Strongly recommended to fix: At the bottom of the page, the "Contact Us" link points to an incorrect location, and the phone number is not linked. Both should be corrected.

This issue is also applicable on the "Terms and Conditions" page.

Mobile: Home page

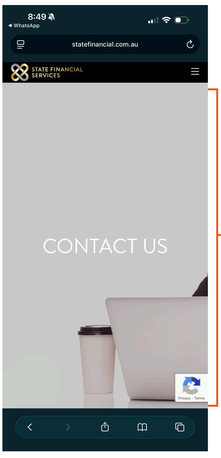


Strongly recommended to fix: This is the second homepage swipe banner, but no text appears and the human face in the image is cut off, which affects the perceived quality.

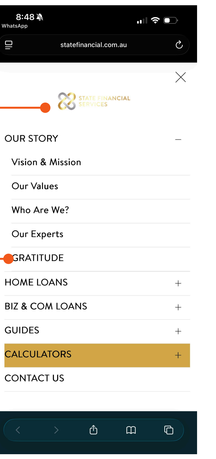
Reducing the image size is recommended.

Adding a CTA is also highly important.

Strongly recommended to fix: The carousel arrows are not working at this stage. While swipe works, users may try to click the arrows as well, so it's better to fix the arrow links to ensure both swipe and click work.

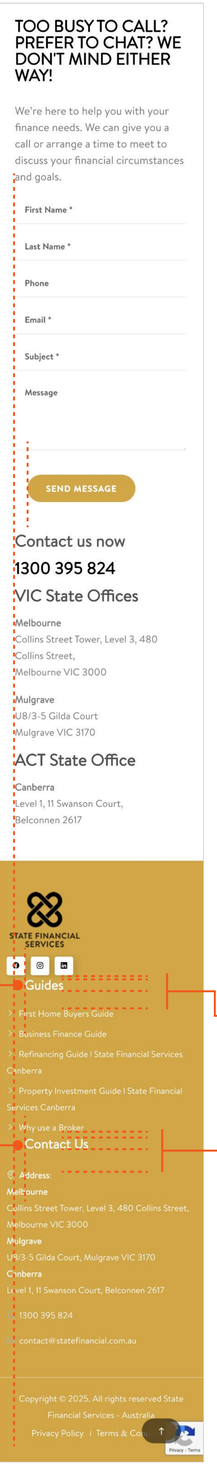


Strongly recommended to fix: Most of the images are cut off. It's highly recommended to reduce the image height (this issue will be fixed) in the mobile view and add a CTA to improve usability and support lead generation.



Strongly recommended to fix: The logo should be replaced with a clearer version, as the current one is not easily visible, which affects company branding.

Strongly recommended to fix: Only the Gratitude page uses uppercase text, even for subsections, while other pages use title case. This inconsistency should be fixed to maintain visual consistency across the site.



Strongly recommended to fix: Better fix the alignmnet

Strongly recommended to fix: Better fix the alignmnet

Strongly recommended to fix: The spacing should be improved; otherwise, the content looks cluttered and is not clearly grouped.

Design. Develop. Grow.

Thank you!

Ruwanthi (Ru) Somatilaka

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Module Tutor (HCI, UIUX, & Visual Design), Glasgow Caledonian University

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